

June 6, 2026

Editor-in-Chief
Software: Practice and Experience
Wiley

Dear Editor,

I am pleased to submit the enclosed manuscript, “*Paper Agent: A Local-First Human-in-the-Loop Agentic Workspace for Controllable Academic Writing*,” for consideration for publication in *Software: Practice and Experience*.

This paper presents *Paper Agent*, a local-first software platform that integrates AI assistance into the full academic writing workflow while keeping the researcher in control. The system introduces three key contributions: (1) a permission-aware AI interaction model (Chat, Agent, Tools) that separates read-only discussion, reviewable edit proposals, and controlled tool execution; (2) typed workflow pipelines with human checkpoints as first-class gates; and (3) citation verification against multiple scholarly databases (CrossRef, Semantic Scholar, OpenAlex). The implementation comprises approximately 23,000 lines of source code, validated by 227 automated tests with 100% pass rate.

This work aligns with SPE’s focus on practical software engineering contributions. It addresses a real-world problem—the fragmentation of AI-assisted academic writing across disconnected tools—with an implemented, tested, and openly available system. The paper follows SPE’s convention of reporting on a complete system with attention to architecture, testing, performance, and deployment considerations.

This manuscript has not been published and is not under consideration for publication elsewhere. I have no competing interests to disclose. During manuscript preparation, I used LLM tools (GPT-4o and Claude) for language polishing and grammar correction only; I have reviewed all AI-assisted content and take full responsibility for the final manuscript.

I look forward to your consideration.

Sincerely,

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